Silo RPG GM Reference

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Silo RPG GM Reference

Compact table-use sheet for adjudication, pressure, factions, and daily-life complications.

Chapter 30: GM's Quick-Reference Sheets

30.1 Travel Time by Stair

Distance	Fit Citizen	Porter	Citizen with Load / Injured Escort
1-5 levels	10-20 minutes	5-10 minutes	20-30 minutes

Distance	Fit Citizen	Porter	Citizen with Load / Injured Escort
6-15 levels	30-75 minutes	20-40 minutes	1-2 hours
16-30 levels	2-4 hours	1-2 hours	Half a day
31-60 levels	Most of a day	4-6 hours	Full day plus likely overnight stop
61+ levels	An expedition	Brutal all-day run	Multiple days

Fast rule: Any non-Porter crossing more than 20 levels arrives tired, thirsty, and out of place.

Faster rule: When exact timing does not matter, treat a journey as local, serious, or an expedition.

30.2 Security and Response

Zone	Typical SR	First Response	Common Complication
Viewport / IT / Judicial corridors	1-10	IT security, Judicial clerk, armed deputy	Someone already knows the PCs' names
Mayor / Medical / major offices	11-25	Clerk, orderly, deputy	Paper trail and witnesses
Markets / Mids tiers	26-45	Local deputy or informant	Crowds and rumours
Hydroponics / Supply floors	30-50	Foreman or quartermaster	Shortage panic
Down Deep slums / maintenance crawls	45-75	Local toughs, Mechanics, or nobody	Environmental danger
Ghost levels / vents / dead spaces	70-100	No official response until later	The location itself is lethal

30.3 Everyday Costs, Bribes, and Favours

Need	Typical Price
Hot meal with real protein	8-15 chits or a favour
Bed for a night	5 chits, gossip, or guard duty
Stamped form expedited	10-30 chits
Minor infraction ignored	1 meal, 1 bottle, or 1 name
Private off-ledger porter run	15-40 chits

Need	Typical Price
Unofficial Mechanical part	Barter plus leverage
Real medicine	Usually unaffordable; always comes with strings

30.4 Punishments at a Glance

Offence	Likely Outcome
Petty theft / ration skimming	Fines, ration cuts, humiliation
Forgery / repeat theft / black-market dealing	Holding cells, beatings, labour transfer
Infrastructure tampering	Mine labour, suspicion, family blacklisting
Relic possession	Interrogation, disappearance, or coerced informing
Sedition / "I want to go outside"	Cleaning

Chapter 31: Core Play Procedure

31.1 When to Call for Uncertainty

Call for a roll when an action risks official notice, harm or exhaustion, scarce time or resources, or social trust; or when failure would make the next scene more dangerous. Otherwise, let the PCs do it.

31.2 Pressure Tracks

Track	It Measures	Typical Triggers	At 4
Stress	Fear, crowding, guilt, claustrophobia	Riots, cells, family pressure, corpses, Cleaning	Freeze, lash out, confess, or flee
Heat	Official attention	Forgery, cameras, bribery, repeated questions	Raids, tails, arrests, interviews
Fatigue	Physical depletion	Long climbs, hunger, poor sleep, labour, carrying loads	Collapse, tremor, dropped gear, slowed movement

Stress resets to 2 after the crisis; Heat resets to 2 once the official response lands; Fatigue resets to 2 after rest or medical care.

31.3 Consequence Menu

On a mixed success or failure, use one:

- **Time:** They succeed, but lose time and another force acts first.
- **Attention:** They succeed, but draw notice.
- **Wear:** A tool, garment, or consumable is spent or damaged.
- **Strain:** Stress or Fatigue rises.
- **Debt:** Someone helps and now expects repayment.
- **Damage:** Leak, blackout, panic, lockdown, or similar escalation.

31.4 Fail-Forward Reminders

- **Bureaucracy:** They get the paper, but their name is now on it.
- **Stealth:** They avoid capture, but leave a trace or witness.
- **Travel:** They arrive late, dehydrated, or short one item.
- **Social Pressure:** They win the scene, but create resentment or rumour.
- **Repair Work:** The fix holds for now, but needs more parts, labour, or risk.

31.5 Escalation Clocks

For a problem larger than one room, use a four-segment clock. Fill it when the PCs' actions or the situation advance it; when it fills, change the fiction.

- **Authority:** Evidence, angered officials, or a pattern brings an official response.
- **Neighbourhood:** Rumours, shortages, or panic affect the surrounding level.
- **Infrastructure:** A leak, contamination, or power fault worsens.

31.6 Downtime Between Crises

Between crises, each PC can usually do one:

- **Work the Shift**
- **Lay Low**
- **Scrounge**
- **Care for Someone**
- **Ask the Stairs**

Chapter 32: Faction Sheets

Faction	Public Face	Real Objective	Main Leverage	Typical Ask
IT	Efficient stewards	Control knowledge and anomalies	Cameras, archives, access	Recover tech, silence glitches
Judicial	Guardians of the Pact	Normalise fear and obedience	Warrants, trials, informants	Names, leverage, examples
Sheriff's Office	Public law	Stop open chaos	Deputies, patrols, legal force	Witnesses, culprits, calm
Mechanical	Proud labour backbone	Keep the machine alive and autonomous	Repairs, power, labour	Spare parts, warnings, silence
Supply	Neutral inventory keepers	Turn shortages into leverage	Ledgers, stamps, rations	Favours, signatures, delays
Medical	Healers	Manage bodies and social stability	Drugs, records, quarantine	Samples, quiet patients, paperwork
Porters' Union	Tireless runners	Protect flow and neutrality	Routes, speed, gossip	Respect, water, payment
Scrap Syndicates	Hidden operators	Profit from scarcity	Contraband, debt, intimidation	Favours, silence, risky jobs
Flame Watchers	Strange believers	Keep dangerous hope alive	Secret rooms, coded talk, believers	Cover, recruits, proof

32.1 Reading a Faction Fast

To improvise a faction, ask what it fears, what it lacks, who could embarrass it, and what small favour from the PCs would make it useful.

Chapter 33: The Slice-of-Life Engine

33.1 Block Problems (d12)

d12	Problem
1	Brown water trickle from the shared line
2	Someone sleeps in the laundry room and steals heat
3	Another family is forced into an already crowded apartment

d12	Problem
4	The ration ledger does not match the grain sacks
5	A body cannot be moved until paperwork clears
6	Hallway lights fail and replacements are “pending”
7	A child found metal inside a wall cavity
8	A deputy is shaking people down for inspection fees
9	Mould spreads through a sleeping tier
10	The local fixer vanishes with the block chit box
11	A marriage permit is denied
12	A known informant suddenly seems scared

33.2 Inspections and Sweeps (d10)

d10	Trigger
1	A repaired camera finally caught last week’s crime
2	Supply flagged impossible consumption numbers
3	Someone spoke too loudly after Pact Silence
4	Contraband showed up in the wrong class of hands
5	Judicial wants one public arrest
6	A deputy wants revenge disguised as duty
7	Medical flagged sedative-resistant citizens
8	A Porter read the wrong message
9	An air-scrubber fault gives cover for a sweep
10	The inspection is fake; the real target is elsewhere

33.3 Favours Asked of the PCs (d12)

d12	Favour
1	Carry a sealed message
2	Sit with a dying relative during a work shift
3	Learn whether a deputy can be bribed
4	Hide a forbidden object overnight
5	Smuggle fresh water into quarantine
6	Escort a child to a name-gifting ceremony
7	Intimidate a landlord unofficially
8	Deliver a Mechanical part to the wrong doctor

d12	Favour
9	Hold a ration-line place for an injured person
10	Recover a body before Judicial uses it as an example
11	Deliver a forged form before dawn
12	Find out what really happened to a missing worker

33.4 Sudden Shortages (d10)

d10	Shortage
1	Lamp oil
2	Filter cloth
3	Antibiotics
4	Rabbit feed
5	Rivets
6	Boiler sealant
7	Salt
8	Boots in common sizes
9	Clean bandages
10	Good heat tape